

Austin Nye, RHP, Vanderbilt

2026 Stats: 0.00 ERA/10 IP/.800 WHIP/13 K/2 BB/6.5 K:BB

6-2, 210

Metrics

FB: 94.5/19.7 IVB/7.8 HB/-4.8 VAA/5.9 ext/6.2 relH/49.2% zone/50 AA/49.6% usage/2240 rpm

CB: 73/-15.9 IVB/-14 HB/-10.63 VAA/20% zone/40.7 AA/7.6% usage/2350 rpm

SL: 82.1/-4.8 IVB/-6.1 HB/-8.59 VAA/26.5% zone/46.2 AA/37.4% usage/2500 rpm

CH: 79.2/3.7 IVB/14.3 HB/-8.13 VAA/28.6% zone/36.6 AA/5.3% usage/1660

Write-up

Austin Nye entered 2026 as one of the premier sophomore arms in the SEC before an internal brace procedure ended his season after just 10 scoreless innings. While the sample was limited, Nye showcased one of the more intriguing repertoires among underclassmen, pairing a riding mid-90s fastball with three distinctly shaped secondary offerings. None of the secondaries overwhelm hitters with velocity, but each creates uncomfortable angles through exceptional depth and movement separation. The fastball already projects as a professional-caliber offering, while the slider flashes the traits of a future above-average bat-missing pitch. The curveball provides a distinctly different vertical look, and the changeup rounds out a starter's mix despite remaining a developmental offering. Ultimately, Nye's projection hinges less on the quality of the arsenal than on how he returns from surgery, as the underlying traits point toward a future weekend starter with legitimate professional upside.

The fastball is the foundation of Nye's profile and already projects as a professional offering. Sitting comfortably in the mid-90s with nearly 20 inches of induced vertical break, the pitch carries exceptionally well through the top of the strike zone despite coming from a relatively high release. The combination of plus ride and above-average velocity allows it to miss bats without requiring elite spin, while enough arm-side movement prevents it from becoming a purely north-south fastball. Nye consistently worked to the edges rather than living over the heart of the plate, showing the ability to

elevate for chase while still throwing strikes at an above-average clip. Continued refinement of glove-side command would allow the fastball to maximize its traits, but the raw ingredients already point toward an above-average major league heater. 50/55 pitch

The curveball offers one of the more visually distinct shapes in the class, featuring exceptional vertical depth with true top-to-bottom action. Sitting in the low-70s, it provides substantial velocity separation from the fastball while changing eye level effectively. Nye showed feel for landing the pitch early in counts, though it projects more as a strike-stealing weapon than a consistent put-away offering in its current form. The depth is real, but the softer velocity allows hitters additional time to recognize it out of hand. Continued refinement of command beneath the zone could push the pitch into average major league territory. 45/50 pitch

The slider is Nye's primary breaking ball, combining above-average depth with short glove-side movement and excellent spin characteristics. Although the raw shape is impressive, the below-average velocity limits its ultimate ceiling compared to harder professional sliders. Even so, the pitch consistently arrived on a steep plane and generated uncomfortable swings beneath the zone while maintaining clear separation from the curveball. The command already flashes above average, particularly to the glove side against right-handed hitters. Adding a tick or two of velocity or creating slightly later finish would elevate the profile considerably, but as presently constructed it projects as an above-average complementary breaking ball rather than a true wipeout offering. 45/50+ pitch

The changeup remains the least developed pitch in the repertoire but possesses encouraging underlying traits. It features quality velocity separation from the fastball with enough arm-side movement and late depth to project as an effective platoon weapon. Nye showed feel for maintaining fastball arm speed, allowing the pitch to play naturally off the riding heater. The command is still developing and the limited usage leaves questions about its consistency, but the movement profile provides a solid foundation. As the feel continues to improve, the changeup has a realistic chance to become an average professional offering capable of keeping left-handed hitters honest. 40/45+ pitch